APEX LARK - Business Insights Report

Data Analytics Internship · Day 04 · Interactive Excel Dashboard · Sample Superstore (9,993 cleaned order lines, 2014-2017)

TOTAL SALES	TOTAL PROFIT	TOTAL ORDERS	TOTAL CUSTOMERS
$2,296,919	$286,409	5,009	793

1. Dashboard Layout Overview

Header banner - title and subtitle			
Filter bar (dropdown controls) - Region · Category · Month · Year			
KPI: Total Sales	KPI: Total Profit	KPI: Total Orders	KPI: Total Customers
Chart 1 Sales by Region (Column)		**Chart 2** Monthly Sales Trend (Line)	
Chart 3 Profit by Category (Bar)		**Chart 4** Sales Distribution by Category (Pie)	
Top 10 Customers table		**Key Insights** panel	

Every KPI, table and chart is driven by the same Cleaned Data table, so changing a dropdown updates the whole dashboard at once.

2. Key Performance Indicators and Findings

- **Highest-revenue region:** West ($725,458, 32% of sales), ahead of East ($678,500); South is lowest ($391,722).
- **Best category:** Technology - $836,154 sales and $145,455 profit. Furniture sells $741,718 but earns only $18,463 profit (2.5% margin).
- **Best month:** Nov 2017 ($118,448). Across all years Nov, Dec, Sep are the strongest calendar months - a clear Q4 / back-to-school peak.
- **Top customer:** SM-20320 ($25,043), followed by TC-20980 ($19,052) and RB-19360 ($15,117).
- **Overall:** profit margin 12.5%; average order value $458.56. Top quantity sellers are low-ticket items (Staples - 215, Staple envelope - 170, Easy-staple paper - 150 units).

3. Strategic Trends Seen on the Dashboard

- Sales dipped in 2015 ($470,533) after $483,966 in 2014, then grew to $609,206 in 2016 and $733,215 in 2017 (+20% year on year); profit rose every year from $49,556 to $93,439.
- Central earns only $39,706 profit on $501,240 of sales, while West earns $108,418 - revenue size is not translating into profit evenly.
- Deep discounts hurt: the 1,392 lines discounted 30%+ lost $135,364 in total, while undiscounted lines earned $320,988. Worst sub-categories: Tables (-$17,725), Bookcases (-$3,473), Supplies (-$1,189).
- Consumer customers drive 51% of revenue, then Corporate ($706,146) and Home Office ($429,372).

4. Three Actionable Recommendations

1. **Cap deep discounts.** Set a 20% discount ceiling with manager approval above it, starting with Tables, Bookcases and Supplies, the sub-categories with the largest losses.
2. **Fix Furniture and Central-region profitability.** Review pricing, supplier cost and shipping for Furniture, and study what makes West and East profitable so the same practices can be replicated in Central and South.
3. **Invest in Technology and the Q4 peak.** Increase stock and marketing for high-margin Technology products, plan inventory, staffing and campaigns ahead of September-December, and protect high-value customers such as SM-20320 with loyalty offers.

Source: ApexLark_Day04_Interactive_Dashboard.xlsx - all figures come from the cleaned Day 02/03 dataset (9,993 records, 0 missing values, 0 duplicates).